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SALILA PANDE

MANAGING
DIRECTOR,
NOMINEE DIRECTOR
OF SBI, EXECUTIVE
DIRECTOR

SBI CARDS AND
PAYMENT SERVICES LTD

FY25 PAT
₹1,916 CR



RANK 21
**SUMITHA
NANDAN
JAYASANKAR**

EXECUTIVE
DIRECTOR,
PROMOTER

MANAPPURAM
FINANCE LTD

FY25 PAT
₹1,204 CR



RANK 39
**PRAVEENA
RAI**

MD AND CEO

MULTI
COMMODITY
EXCHANGE OF
INDIA LTD

FY25 PAT
₹560 CR

RANK 98
**MANJU
SURESH
BAFNA**

CHAIRPERSON,
EXECUTIVE
DIRECTOR,
PROMOTER

MONARCH
NETWORK
CAPITAL LTD.

FY25 PAT
₹149

RANK 124
**RACHITA
GUPTA**

EXECUTIVE
DIRECTOR,
PROMOTER

CSL
FINANCE LTD

FY25 PAT
₹72 CR

aging the acquisition of the Indian MF business of JP Morgan Mutual Fund in 2016-17.

Gupta points to changes in workplaces that have helped women, like the shift from the old command-and-control model to a more collaborative, empathetic, and flexible style of leadership, qualities where women often thrive. "Policy changes and organisational intent have also helped, but I'd say the biggest shift is cultural—we're finally seeing ambition in women being celebrated, not questioned," says Gupta.

She often comes across many young women today—even from Tier II and III cities—who tell her they want to be CEOs. That mindset didn't exist a generation ago. There are stories, role models, and a growing belief that these ambitions are achievable. Besides, some women have incredible family and support systems around them. "I always tell young girls: use that support well; it's your superpower," says Gupta.

Amisha Vora, owner, Chairperson & Managing Director of PL Capital, believes that the BFSI sector has nurtured more women leaders because it is inherently merit-driven and performance-oriented. "In financial services, outcomes are tangible and measurable, which naturally limits the role of bias or informal networks that may influence career growth elsewhere. Moreover, the very nature of the sector—underwriting, risk evaluation, and long-term decision-making—aligns strongly with qualities many women bring," she says.

THE X FACTOR

Experience shows that women often bring qualities that serve particularly well in finance. "Earlier, leadership was largely defined by authority, speed, and decisiveness. Today, it is increasingly defined by clarity, emotional intelligence, and the ability to create alignment," says Vora. Financial institutions are recognis-